

Northwind Retail plc - Sharesave Participant Guide

Save As You Earn (SAYE) scheme | Document reference NWR-SHR-004 | Version 4.2 | Effective 1 April 2026 | Owner: Reward Operations

1. About this guide

This guide explains how the Northwind Retail plc Sharesave scheme is operated. It describes the terms Northwind has chosen within the limits set by HMRC. Where this guide differs from general HMRC guidance, it is because Northwind has adopted terms that are narrower than the statutory maximum. This guide does not replace your option certificate or your savings contract.

2. Scheme terms

Term	Northwind scheme	Statutory position
Monthly savings range	GBP 10 to GBP 250	GBP 5 to GBP 500
Savings period offered	3 years only	3 or 5 years
Option price discount	15% of market value	up to 20%
Invitation frequency	Once a year	At employer discretion
Qualifying service	6 months at invitation date	up to 5 years

Northwind does not offer 5-year contracts and has not done so since the 2021 invitation. Participants holding a legacy 5-year contract granted in 2019 or 2020 continue under the terms of that grant.

3. Annual invitation

The Sharesave invitation opens on the first Monday of September each year and closes at 23:59 on 30 September. Applications received after the closing date cannot be accepted and the employee must wait for the following year's invitation. Option certificates are issued within 30 days of the closing date and the first salary deduction is taken in the November payroll.

4. Changing your contribution

The monthly savings amount is fixed for the whole of the savings contract and cannot be increased or decreased once the contract has started. This is a requirement of the savings contract, not a Northwind rule, and no exceptions can be made.

If your circumstances change, the options available to you are to pause contributions (section 5) or to close the contract and withdraw your savings (section 6). If you want to save a different amount, you must wait for the next annual invitation and apply for a new contract.

5. Pausing contributions

You may miss up to 6 monthly contributions across the life of the contract. Each missed contribution delays your maturity date by one calendar month. You do not need to give a reason and you do not need approval, but you must notify Reward Operations through the Northwind Share Plan Portal before the payroll cut-off, which is the 12th of the month.

If a 7th contribution is missed, the savings contract is automatically closed. Your savings to date are returned to your nominated bank account within 21 days and the option lapses. This is automatic and cannot be reversed.

Contributions are not taken during unpaid leave. Months of unpaid leave count towards the 6 permitted missed contributions.

6. Leaving the scheme before maturity

You may close your savings contract at any time through the Northwind Share Plan Portal. Your savings are returned to your nominated bank account within 21 days. No bonus is payable on a contract closed before maturity and your option lapses immediately. A closed contract cannot be reinstated.

7. Leaving Northwind Retail

Your treatment depends on your leaver category.

Leaver category	Includes	What happens to the option
Good leaver	Redundancy, retirement, injury, disability, transfer to another business or division of the group	Option may be exercised within 6 months of leaving, using savings and any bonus due
Bad leaver	Resignation, dismissal, any other reason	Option lapses on the leaving date; savings and any bonus due are returned

Leaver category is determined by HR and confirmed in your leaver letter. Queries about categorisation are handled by HR Services, not by Reward Operations.

8. Maturity

Northwind writes to participants 60 days before the maturity date. You must submit a maturity instruction through the Northwind Share Plan Portal within 30 calendar days of the maturity date, choosing one of three outcomes:

(a) exercise the option and hold the shares in the Northwind nominee account; (b) exercise the option and sell the shares immediately, with proceeds paid through payroll in the following month; or (c) take the savings and any bonus in cash, letting the option lapse.

If no instruction is received within 30 calendar days, the default outcome applies: the savings and any bonus are returned to your nominated bank account and the option lapses. Northwind cannot reverse a default outcome, even where the option was in the money.

9. Contacts and service levels

Query type	Contact	Response time
Scheme rules, contributions, maturity date	Reward Operations, sharesave@northwindretailplc.com	5 working days
Leaver categorisation	HR Services	10 working days
Portal access and login	IT Service Desk, extension 4400	1 working day
Tax on your personal circumstances	Not handled internally - seek independent advice	

Northwind Retail plc and Reward Operations do not provide financial, investment or tax advice. Nothing in this guide is a recommendation to join the scheme, to exercise an option or to sell shares. This document is fictional and was produced for training purposes only; Northwind Retail plc is not a real company.